In the workshop with... Shaun & Jessica Stacey

We meet a father and daughter turning team in their idyllic lake-side workshop

This month, we visit the Somerset workshop of Shaun Stacey and his daughter Jessica. Shaun began turning as a hobby several years ago, and Jessica was soon inspired to try her hand at it too. Here, they tell us about their inspirations, favourite things to turn, plans for the future and more…

PHOTOGRAPHS BY SHAUN AND JESSICA STACEY

How, when and why did you start turning?

Shaun Stacey: I started turning 12 years ago, after being given a woodturning lesson as a birthday present. Having a young family at the time, the speed of completing the project in the limited spare time I had was a big attraction. I was also at the time running our large construction business as well as travelling the world shooting clay pigeons for the Great Britain and England teams. The time I had for turning was limited so twice a year I would go on a course with Tobias Kayne to keep my hand in. This period was all about learning to use the tools properly and understanding shape.

Jessica Stacey: When dad started bringing home things that he had made, I wanted to have a go. So when we had the workshop, I went up with dad to help clean up, paint and sand things. I ended up loving it!

I started helping out in the workshop when I was about eight years old; I'm now 13. I have started to turn bowls myself within the last year, with occasional guidance from dad.

What and who are the greatest influences in your work?

SS: The main person who has influenced my work is my great friend Nick Agar. I can clearly remember watching him blow colour onto his work and watching the instant transformation and thinking WOW! Nick has helped me in so many ways, but getting me to open my mind and eyes to see the world around means that almost everything has some sort of influence. Every minute I spend in Nick's company is priceless!

Another artist who just blows my mind with his work is Alain Mailand. Just a quick look at the gallery on his website starts the brain asking, 'how did he make that?'.

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